

CEO BLUES

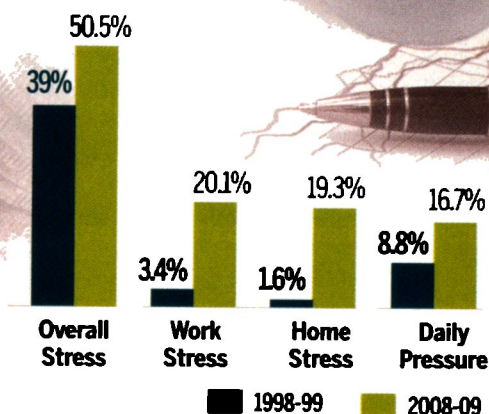
The pressure to perform sets their teeth on edge

A whopping **21%** more happy with compensation

...so money is not the issue...

...nor is work load

Just **31%** feel overworked, against 45.2% in 1998-99



10% rise in alcohol intake in the last 10 years



10% more take to smoking while there is a 12% increase in chewing paan



“Today’s corporate honchos are facing ever stronger economic headwinds as well as more pressure from the stakeholders for breakthrough results.”

diet and lack of fitness—has come to indicate slovenliness and a lack of discipline: “The top boss must, therefore, demonstrate that he is in perfect control of his own domain, not only in deeds and words but in his own flesh,” adds Krohe.

Nothing succeeds like success. “All the successful people today, from Barack Obama to Anil Ambani, are very particular about fitness,” says Vidhur Sodhani, who notices rising footfalls at his Elemention gym in Gurgaon. That inspires others. “Executives today are moving around the world and need to sport an inter-

national, leaner, clean-cut, corporate look,” he adds. “Employers relate efficiency directly with fitness and many buy gym membership for their employees.” Says Saurabh Khanna, associate director of training, “Working out in a gym has a lot to do with social status these days.” Like restaurants and bars, young executives like to hang out in gyms and network socially, he adds.

“Corporates are trying to create a fitness-friendly culture, too,” says Pooja Makhija, dietician with Clay Wellness in Mumbai, who has counselled over 5,000 corporate bosses,

professionals and socialites. She finds most of her corporate clients wired up. “They work round the clock, get fewer breaks, are time-starved and can’t seem to switch off,” she says. A huge concern to companies, who are now sending out a new message: We want to help you improve so that you’re more productive. The key to better performance is a healthy diet, says Makhija. “Lots of firms have now introduced nutrition as a part of the perks that they gift to their employees. Regular visits by nutritionists, to chart out diet plans for employees, are quite standard these

